

Brian Keller — game-calling card

RHP · 36° slot · 4 pitches · AAA 2026: 8 GS · 36.2 IP · 146 BF · prepared for J.T. Realmuto · UC #27 (uc-pps-022)

Cutter to start it. Sinker at the knees, not under them. Slider to finish it — especially to lefties.

Two strikes — the main event

vs LHB (85 BF · 22.0% whiff/swing · 22.4% K · all 5 HR)

Pitch	% of 2K calls	n	Whiff/sw	Putaway
4-Seam Fastball	58%	49	18.2%	18.4%
Cutter	15%	13	25.0%	30.8%
Slider	15%	13	60.0%	30.8%
Sinker	11%	9	16.7%	11.1%

vs RHB (61 BF · 30.3% whiff/swing · 31.1% K · 0 HR)

Pitch	% of 2K calls	n	Whiff/sw	Putaway
4-Seam Fastball	61%	44	26.9%	25.0%
Slider	29%	21	45.5%	23.8%
Sinker	6%	4	33.3%	25.0%

The one change worth making. The four-seam takes 58% of two-strike calls to lefties and whiffs at 18.2% — his worst put-away pitch getting the most put-away calls. The slider whiffs at 60.0% there on 13 pitches. Move calls from the first row to the last.

First pitch — get to 0-1

vs LHB

Pitch	% of 0-0	n	Strike rate
Cutter	26%	22	72.7%
4-Seam Fastball	41%	35	68.6%
Slider	6%	5	60.0%
Sinker	26%	22	54.5%

vs RHB

Pitch	% of 0-0	n	Strike rate
Cutter	29%	17	76.5%
4-Seam Fastball	29%	17	70.6%
Sinker	25%	15	46.7%
Slider	15%	9	33.3%

The arsenal — what each pitch is for

Pitch	Use	Velo	Whiff/sw	Hard-hit (n BIP)	GB%
4-Seam	43%	92.6	24.6%	48.8% (41)	37%
Cutter	24%	87.9	20.0%	46.7% (30)	43%
Sinker	18%	91.2	26.8%	6.7% (15)	47%
Slider	14%	81.2	37.5%	11.1% (9)	67%

Staff baselines: whiff/swing 26.3% · hard-hit 38.0% · GB 47.0%. Green = contact suppressors, currently under-used. Red numbers = damage pitches.

Location — set the target here

	Keller	Staff	What it means
4-seam above zone	34.8%	25.5%	elevated approach on 92.6 mph
4-seam mean height	2.96 ft	2.65 ft	4 of 5 HR at ≥2.75 ft
Sinker mean height	2.05 ft	2.35 ft	0.30 ft too low
Sinker at zone edge	14.4%	28.8%	half the staff rate
Sinker in chase zone	43.3%	27.8%	being wasted

The sinker is his best pitch and he throws it like a waste pitch. 6.7% hard-hit, 75.4 mph average exit velocity — and it's under the zone. Set the glove at the knees, not below them.

Leash — when to get him

Times through	BF	wOBA	SLG	HR
1st	72	0.248	0.277	1
2nd	58	0.325	0.481	4
3rd (tiny)	16	0.157	0.133	0

Inning	1	2	3	4	5	6
4-seam velo	93.6	93.0	92.4	92.1	91.0	90.5

~3.1 mph by the sixth. Below ~91 the elevated four-seam is a strike, not a chase pitch — stop calling it as a put-away.

Five things to hold in your head

1. Fewer two-strike fastballs to lefties. Biggest single gain available.
2. Cutter starts the at-bat — best strike rate he owns, both sides.
3. Sinker at the knees — turns a wasted pitch into a strike from his softest-contact offering.
4. Second time through a lefty, change the look. 4 of 5 HR, all LHB, mostly 2nd pass.
5. He'll throw strikes. 7.5% walk rate, 0 walks in his last 3 starts. Expand the zone with him, don't nibble.

Read this with the report. All AAA, 146 BF, no MLB track record. Splits below ~20 PA (slider, sinker, every two-strike cell) are directional only — the n is printed on every line for that reason. Full caveats: dp_uc26_keller_lhv_2026_report.pdf \$8.